priorities.[53] Guterres also leaned on collaborations with other IOs, civil society groups, and private corporations to fill gaps created by US skepticism. His efforts to incorporate technology into peacekeeping further reduced the organization's reliance on member states like the United States, which had become increasingly disengaged under Trump's leadership.[54]

Guterres concomitantly engaged Trump in private meetings, leveraging personal diplomacy to maintain the US commitment to the UN. These conversations allowed Trump to publicly posture as a critic while privately cooperating with the organization.[55] Guterres also appealed to the American public, countering Trump's inflammatory rhetoric on social media. For instance, when Trump derided the UN as "a club for people to get together, talk, and have a good time," Guterres responded on Snapchat by emphasizing the institution's untapped potential and his commitment to realizing it. He even extended goodwill to Trump by wishing him a swift recovery when he contracted COVID-19, signaling an effort to maintain a personal connection despite their differences.[56]

These strategies proved effective in tempering Trump's hostility. In May 2018, Trump tweeted praise for Guterres, lauding his efforts to "Make the United Nations Great Again" and highlighting cost savings achieved through reduced US involvement. Ultimately, Trump's funding cuts were more modest than his initial threats, with the US share of the peacekeeping budget decreasing from 28.5 percent to 25 percent, amounting to a reduction of $200 million in spending.[57] This was a nominal price for the UN to pay to maintain Trump's broad cooperation.

However, the long-term effects of Trump's policies remain uncertain. Many of the reforms implemented under his administration were reversed when President Biden restored US support for multilateral initiatives. Yet populist grievances regarding the UN persist, as evidenced by recent congressional debates over peacekeeping funds.[58] While Guterres's strategies effectively navigated Trump's first presidency, they underscore the precarious balance required to maintain US engagement in multilateral organizations amid growing populist pressures.